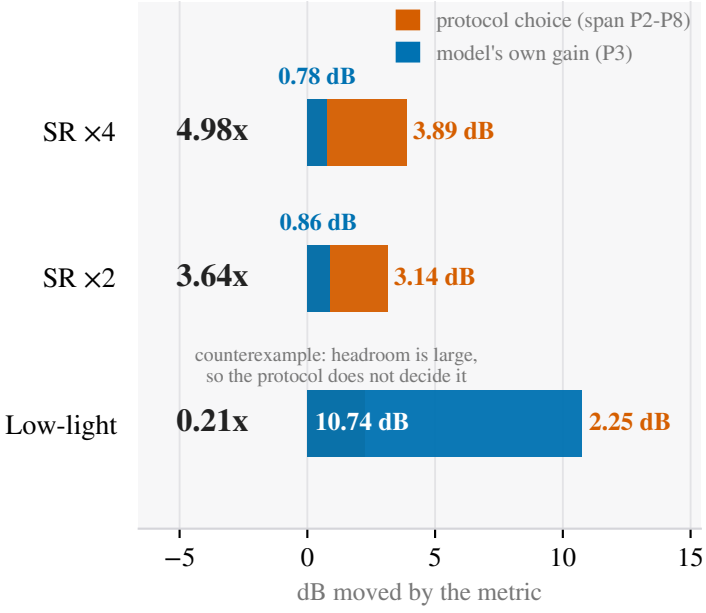
The protocol is the result

21 protocol cells x 5 seeds = 105 evaluations

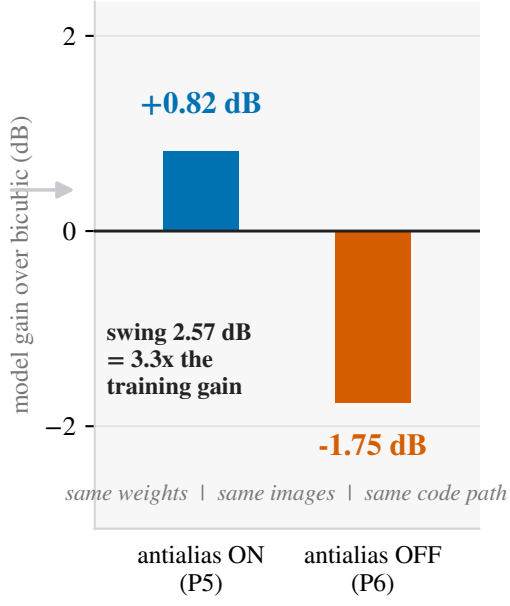
In lightweight image restoration, the evaluation protocol -- not the model -- often decides what the reported number says.

SR x4 / SR x2 / low-light

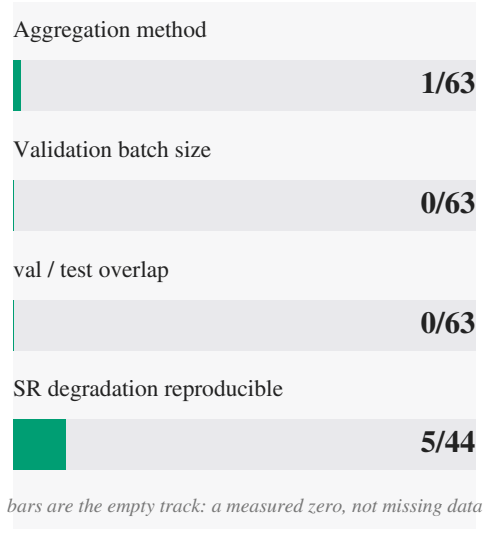
A protocol choice moves the number further than the model does



One boolean flips the verdict



What 63 recent papers report



Report the protocol: aggregation, validation set, sampling window, channel and shave, degradation operator, seeds.

The claim is conditional: on low-light the protocol spans 2.25 dB against a 10.74 dB training gain, so it does not decide the result.